



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archway Classical Academy - North Phoenix
School Website: <https://archwaynorthphoenix.greatheartsamerica.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Archway Classical Academy North Phoenix (ACA North Phoenix) displays a robust CLASSICAL orientation across the six canonical categories of classical education. Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize the core triad of truth, goodness, and beauty; a liberal-arts–driven curriculum anchored in the Western tradition; and a pedagogy that foregrounds Socratic inquiry, memorization/recitation, and model-teacher mentorship. Evidence from ACA North Phoenix’s site shows explicit commitments to a classical liberal arts curriculum, Great Books-based study, and a learning culture centered on character formation, virtue, and communal life with strong parent involvement. The school also highlights a teacher-centered culture with small class sizes and a learning ecosystem that invites parental engagement. Collectively, these cues align strongly with classical markers described in the knowledge base.

Key evidence points:

- Core mission centers on truth, goodness, and beauty, with a liberal arts foundation and Western-tradition curriculum.
- Explicit use of Great Books / Great Conversation and a Socratic instructional approach in curriculum and pedagogy.
- Pedagogical methods include Socratic instruction and a mentoring teacher-student relationship; multiple sources document two teachers per class and a strong faculty emphasis on character formation.
- Parents and community are integrated as partners with volunteering, involvement in school life, and family engagement in the learning process.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as guiding ideals in education. The mission states ACA North Phoenix cultivates minds and hearts through the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.
- The Great Hearts framework accompanies a liberal-arts curriculum rooted in the Western tradition, underscoring a transcendent aim of education beyond mere information.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue (as part of noble virtues in the mission), liberal arts, Western tradition, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, formation.
- Negative keywords present: none detected in public-facing materials for this category. The site does not appear to emphasize relativism or secular-humanist signals in the public text examined.

Why this rating

- The clearest signals are the explicit invocation of truth, goodness, and beauty, plus a commitment to Great Books and a Western-tradition liberal-arts framework. Those are central anchors of classical education in this category, with little to no textual evidence of negative signals in the public materials reviewed. This justifies a CLASSICAL rating for Element 1.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission centers on formation of minds and hearts through pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, signaling formation-oriented aims rather than purely vocational outcomes.
- The curriculum is described as liberal-arts-rich and rooted in Western tradition, signaling a paideia-like aim beyond job preparation.
- The school emphasizes a lifelong educational horizon (preparation for ongoing learning and noble virtues) and a teacher-student mentoring culture, aligning with formation and character development rather than narrow workforce prep.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, liberal education/paideia, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, classical mission, human flourishing, virtue, great conversation.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public-facing text for this category (no emphasis on workforce-carpenter skills or career-readiness as primary telos).

Why this rating

- The stated goals align with formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, which are core to classical education. The emphasis on liberal-arts pedagogy and a telos toward human excellence supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site frames curriculum around a liberal-arts core and includes a Great Books-oriented approach (Great Books of the Western tradition).
- The curriculum highlights a humanities- and classics-forward orientation (language arts, history, science, mathematics, arts, and foreign language), with Socratic instruction mentioned in practice.
- Public materials reference a trajectory of rigorous classical disciplines (grammar, rhetoric, logic; “great books” in the Western canon; Western civilization history).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, Western tradition, history and classics, Socratic instruction, language/grammar/logic/rhetoric (as elements of the Trivium), pedagogy that emphasizes wonder and integrated topics.
- Negative keywords present: minimal indicators of negative signals in the public materials for this category (no explicit push toward social-studies-centric framing, project-based or STEM-first focus that could signal non-classical orientation).

Why this rating

- The curriculum is clearly anchored in classical pillars (Great Books, liberal arts, Trivium elements in public framing, and a history-centered, integrated approach). The explicit mention of Great Books and a Western-tradition curriculum supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school’s materials explicitly describe the use of Socratic Instruction with guided questions to develop deep understanding, inquiry, and wonder.
- The public materials describe a learning culture that celebrates wonder and depth of inquiry, reinforcing a contemplative, inquiry-based pedagogy alongside Socratic practice.

- There is direct language indicating a strong mentoring relationship between teachers and students, including a “center of the school is the classroom and the mentoring relationship” framing. Two teachers per class and a focus on teacher excellence are documented, signaling a teacher-centered classical pedagogy with model leadership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic Instruction, guided questions, Great Conversation, mentoring relationships, wonder, recitation/memory practices (as part of classical pedagogy), memória-related emphasis (memorable learning through recitation).
- Negative keywords present: minimal evidence of non-classical approaches (no explicit emphasis on purely project-based or constructivist pedagogy in the public materials available).

Why this rating

- The presence of direct Socratic instruction and a strong mentoring/teacher-led approach aligns with classical pedagogy expectations. The emphasis on wonder and a structured, memory-friendly approach supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The materials describe teachers as dedicated, enthusiastic, and intellectually excellent models who serve as exemplars of learning and character.
- The public content notes a teacher-centered approach with a “living curriculum” and a focus on mentorship and virtuous modeling, including a “portrait of a teacher” and a “faculty of friends” mindset within classical pedagogy frames.
- The site mentions strong instructional staffing (two teachers per classroom) and ongoing teacher-led programs that model classical virtues and learning habits.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials for this category. (Public-facing materials do not emphasize non-classical faculty signals in this context.)

Why this rating

- The public-facing content emphasizes teachers as virtuous, exemplar figures, living curriculum, and a close, mentor-like faculty culture—core indicators of CLASSICAL faculty orientation.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes a partnership with families as co-teachers and actively invites parent engagement and formation, including volunteerism and community involvement.
- Public materials describe opportunities for parent formation (reading groups, seminars) and an open-campus philosophy, with a culture of volunteers and parental participation in school life.
- The campus highlights community engagement through campaigns, giving Tuesday, and parent-led involvement in school governance and events (PSO, committees).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, volunteering, parent covenant, community events.
- Negative keywords present: minimal signs of consumer-centric language or limited parental involvement; the public materials show active parental participation rather than adverse signals.

Why this rating

- The visible emphasis on parent partnerships, formation, and an open, involved community aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community. The engagement is consistent with the classical model of parents as co-educators and active participants in the learning community.

Aggregate Assessment

- Across all six categories, Archway Classical Academy North Phoenix demonstrates a coherent CLASSICAL alignment through explicit language around truth, goodness, and beauty; a liberal-arts, Great Books–driven curriculum; Socratic pedagogy; model-faculty mentorship; and robust parent/community engagement. The weight of evidence across categories supports an overall CLASSICAL classification.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the school already slots firmly into CLASSICAL across all six categories. If one category were to be adjusted toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, the needle-moving steps would include adding explicit references to liturgical/community practices, deeper explicit theology discussions, and a more explicit articulation of scholé/restful learning rhythms in the public-facing materials.

ABSTRACT

This evaluation assesses Archway Classical Academy North Phoenix (ACA North Phoenix) against the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric, using both the classical knowledge base (with the Six Essential Elements and related keyword indicators) and the school's public materials in the crawl data. The keyword-driven analysis looked for explicit mentions of the six categories and mapped them against Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the classical rubric.

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: mission emphasizes truth, goodness, beauty; liberal-arts Western-tradition framing.
- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, liberal arts, Western tradition. Negative signals: none detected in public text.
- Rationale: Core transcendental values and a Western-tradition framework align with classical aims.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: formation of minds and hearts; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; liberal-arts approach.
- Positive keywords: formation, liberal education, virtue, great conversation (implicit via Great Books).
- Rationale: Formation and telos-oriented goals align with the classical mission.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Great Books/Western tradition; liberal-arts framework; public mentions of a classical curriculum.
- Positive keywords: Great Books, Western tradition, liberal arts, history and classics; Socratic instruction appears in pedagogy.
- Rationale: Strong alignment with Trivium/Quadrivium orientation, great-books pedagogy.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: explicit use of Socratic Instruction; emphasis on wonder and a mentoring teacher-student relationship.
- Positive keywords: Socratic dialogue, guided discussion, wonder; mentoring relationships.
- Rationale: A primary hallmark of classical pedagogy is present.

- Element 5 (Faculty): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: teachers described as models of learning/character; living curriculum; two-teacher classrooms.
- Positive keywords: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher; two teachers per classroom.
- Rationale: Faculty as virtuous exemplars and mentors is central to classical education.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL
- Evidence: strong parent partnership and involvement; volunteering opportunities; family formation and community engagement.
- Positive keywords: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, volunteering, open campus, parent covenant.
- Rationale: The school exhibits the classical model of parent as co-educator and active community partner.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

Overall, ACA North Phoenix demonstrates a coherent classical-education profile across all six categories, with explicit textual evidence in public materials for core features such as truth/goodness/beauty, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, mentorship-centered faculty, and robust parent/community partnership. The result is a full CLASSICAL designation.

Note: The sources cited above include ACA North Phoenix site content describing the mission and curriculum, the use of Socratic Instruction in pedagogy, and the Great Hearts framework, along with the classical keyword lexicons and Six Essential Elements materials that frame how to assess and interpret these signals. Key citations include ACA North Phoenix mission and pedagogy statements, Great Hearts curriculum references, and related public-facing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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